

Artilody Soundsculp

User Manual – English

Version 1.0.0

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1. Introduction

Artilody Soundsculp is a simple audio editor. You can open several audio files at once (each file becomes a **track**), create empty tracks, cut and copy audio between tracks, improve the sound with effects and finally export a single track or all tracks mixed into one file.

Features: mouse selection, trim, cut/copy/paste, fade in and out, normalize, silence trim, loop, reverse, pitch shifting without changing the speed, a parametric EQ, a noise remover, a volume line on every track, text markers, recording from a microphone, and export to WAV, FLAC, MP3, OGG, AIFF, M4A and Opus.

Every change can be undone. The original file is never modified – the result is only written when you export.

2. Installation

Download the installer from the **Releases** page at `github.com/shenphenchoedron-hue/Artilody-Soundsculp`.

Windows (10 and 11)

1. Download `ArtilodySoundsculp-1.0.0-Windows-Setup.exe`.
2. Double-click it. If Windows SmartScreen shows "Windows protected your PC", click **More info** and then **Run anyway**.
3. Follow the wizard. The program and the manuals are then available in the Start menu.

A *Portable* zip is also available – unpack it and run the program without installing.

macOS (11 or newer, Intel and Apple Silicon)

1. Download `ArtilodySoundsculp-1.0.0-macOS-Universal.dmg` and open it.

2. Drag **Artilody Soundsculp** into the **Applications** folder.
3. The first time: right-click (or ctrl-click) the app, choose **Open** and confirm with **Open**. The app is not notarised by Apple, so macOS asks once. If that does not help, open Terminal and type: `xattr -cr "/Applications/Artilody Soundsculp.app"`
4. The first time you record, macOS asks for microphone access – answer **OK**.

Debian (12+) and Ubuntu (22.04 / 24.04)

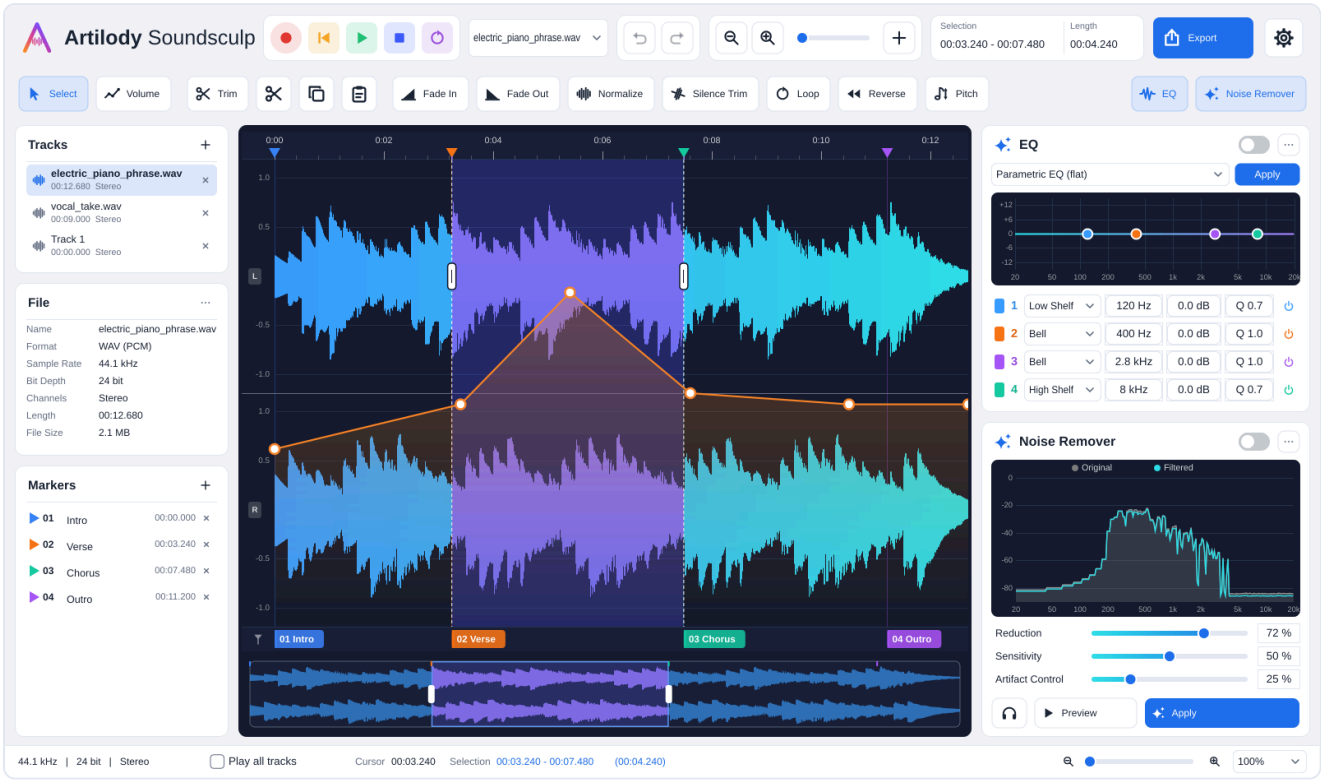
Download the `.deb` file for your system (`debian-12` or `ubuntu-22.04-24.04`) and install it with:

`sudo apt install ./artilody-soundsculp_1.0.0_debian-12_amd64.deb`

The program then appears in the application menu under **Sound & Video**, or start it with the command `artilody-soundsculp`. The package recommends `ffmpeg`, which is used for MP3, M4A and Opus export. If it was not installed automatically: `sudo apt install ffmpeg`.

Uninstall with `sudo apt remove artilody-soundsculp`.

3. The main window



Area	Description
Top bar	Logo, transport buttons (record, go to start, play, stop, loop), track selector, undo/redo, zoom, **+** (tracks menu), selection and length display, **Export** and settings (gear).
Toolbar	Select, Volume, Trim, Cut, Copy, Paste, Fade In, Fade Out, Normalize, Silence Trim, Loop, Reverse, Pitch. On the right: buttons that show/hide the EQ and the Noise Remover.
Tracks (left)	All open tracks. Click to select, **×** closes the track, **+** opens the tracks menu. An asterisk (*) means changes that are not exported yet.
File (left)	Name, format, sample rate, bit depth, channels, length and file size of the selected track.
Markers (left)	The list of text markers. This is where you type the text of each marker.
Waveform (centre)	Time ruler at the top, the channels (L/R), the orange volume line and the **marker line** at the bottom. Below it is the overview of the whole track.
EQ and Noise Remover (right)	Parametric 4-band EQ and noise remover with spectrum display.
Status bar	Format, **Play all tracks**, cursor position, selection, messages and zoom.

4. Tracks: open, create, insert and merge

Opening audio files

Click **+** (in the top bar or the Tracks panel) and choose **Open audio files…** (`Ctrl+O`). You can select several files at once, or drag files into the window. Each file opens as a new track.

Supported formats: WAV, AIFF, FLAC, OGG, MP3 – and with ffmpeg also M4A/AAC, Opus, WMA and more.

New empty track

Choose **+** → **New empty track** (`Ctrl+N`). An empty track shows 30 seconds so you can click a position. Then you can:

- **Insert an audio file**: **+** → **Insert audio file at cursor…**. The file is inserted where you clicked.
- **Copy a piece from another track**: select the other track, select an area, press **Copy** (`Ctrl+C`), select the empty track, click the position and press **Paste** (`Ctrl+V`).

If you click after the end of the audio, the gap is filled with silence automatically. Different sample rates or channel counts are converted automatically.

Merging tracks into one track

Choose **+** → **Merge tracks into one track…**. Tick the tracks to include and press **Merge**. The tracks are mixed together (all starting at 0:00) into a new track called "Merged track". Volume lines are included and markers are copied. If the mix gets too loud, the level is reduced automatically to avoid clipping. Optionally tick *Close the merged tracks afterwards*.

> If you just want all tracks in one file, use **Export** → **All tracks mixed into one file** (see section 13). Turn on **Play all tracks** in the status bar to hear the mix first.

Other track functions

The tracks menu also has **Duplicate track**, **Rename track…** and **Close track**.

5. Selecting with the mouse

- **Drag** in the waveform to select. The selection turns purple.
- Drag the white handles at the edges to adjust start and end. `Shift`+click extends the selection.
- A single click removes the selection and sets the cursor (the white line).
- **Double-click** selects the part between two markers – for example a whole verse.
- `Ctrl+A` selects the whole track. Click in the time ruler to move the cursor.

Start, end and length are shown in the top bar and the status bar.

6. Editing

Most effects work on the selection. With nothing selected they work on the whole track.

Button	Function
Trim (`Ctrl+T`)	Keeps only the selection and removes the rest.
Cut (`Ctrl+X`)	Removes the selection and puts it on the clipboard.
Copy (`Ctrl+C`)	Copies the selection to the clipboard.
Paste (`Ctrl+V`)	Inserts at the cursor or replaces the selection. Also works between tracks.
`Delete`	Deletes the selection.
Fade In / Fade Out	Smoothly fades the selection in/out. Without a selection the first/last 3 seconds are used.
Normalize	Raises (or lowers) the level so the loudest peak is at −0.1 dB.
Silence Trim	Removes silence at the start and end. You enter the threshold in dB (default −50 dB).
Loop	Repeats the selection a chosen number of times (with tiny crossfades to avoid clicks).
Reverse	Reverses the selection.
Pitch	Raises or lowers the pitch without changing the speed (see section 7).

7. Pitch

Click **Pitch**. Choose between −12 and +12 semitones (in steps of 0.1). The −12, −1, +1, +12 buttons give quick choices. Press **Preview** to listen (up to 10 seconds) and **Apply** to keep the change. Length and tempo are preserved.

8. Parametric EQ

The EQ has 4 bands. Each band has a **type** (Low Shelf, Bell, High Shelf, Low Cut, High Cut, Notch), **frequency**, **gain** (dB), **Q** (width) and an on/off button.

- Drag the coloured points in the curve: horizontal = frequency, vertical = gain. The mouse wheel over a point changes Q. Double-click resets the gain.
- Values can also be changed by dragging the fields, or double-clicking and typing a value.
- The drop-down at the top has presets (Bass boost, Vocal presence, Warmth, Remove rumble, Telephone …).
- The switch at the top right lets you **hear the EQ live** during playback.

- **Apply** applies the EQ permanently to the selection (or the whole track). Then turn the switch off so you do not hear it twice.

9. Noise Remover

The noise remover reduces constant background noise (hiss, hum, fans).

1. For the best result: select a part containing **only noise** and choose **…** → **Learn noise profile from selection**. The switch turns on. Without a learned profile the noise is estimated automatically.
2. Select what to clean (or nothing for the whole track).
3. Adjust **Reduction** (how much the noise is reduced), **Sensitivity** (how much is treated as noise) and **Artifact Control** (smoothing against "watery" sound).
4. The spectrum shows the original (grey) and the filtered result (cyan). Press **Preview** to listen (up to 15 s). The headphones button lets you hear *only the noise being removed*.
5. Press **Apply**.

10. The volume line

Each track has an orange volume line that controls the level over time without changing the audio itself. It is used for playback, merging and export.

- Choose the **Volume** tool and click on the waveform to add points. Drag points up and down (and sideways). The middle is 0 dB (unchanged), the top is +6 dB and the bottom is silence. The value is shown while dragging.
- With the **Select** tool you can still drag existing points, and double-click the line to add new ones.
- Right-click a point to delete it. **File panel** → **…** → **Reset volume line** removes all points.

11. Text markers

Markers show, for example, where a verse or chorus starts.

- Click on the **marker line** below the waveform to add a marker. The text field in the **Markers** panel on the left becomes active – type the text (e.g. "Verse 1") and press `Enter`.
- The marker is shown as a coloured label on the marker line, a triangle on the time ruler and a thin line through the waveform.
- Drag a marker to move it. Right-click to rename, select to the next marker or delete.
- **+** in the Markers panel (or the `M` key) adds a marker at the cursor – also during playback.
- Click a marker in the list to jump to it. **×** deletes the marker.

12. Playback and recording

Button	Function
● Record (`R`)	Starts recording on a new track. The button lights up red while recording. Press it again or Stop to finish.
⏮ Go to start (`Home`)	Moves the cursor to the start.
▶ Play (`Space`)	Plays from the cursor or the start of the selection. The button lights up green while playing.
■ Stop	Stops playback or recording.
⟳ Loop (`L`)	Repeats the selection (or the whole track) during playback.

Play all tracks in the status bar plays all tracks mixed together. Audio devices (microphone and speakers) are chosen under **Settings** → **Audio settings…**.

13. Export

Click **Export** (`Ctrl+E`) and choose what to export:

- **Current track** – the whole selected track.
- **Selection only** – only the selected area.
- **All tracks mixed into one file** – all tracks combined.

Then choose the format and file name. The volume line is always included.

Format	Note
WAV 16 / 24 / 32-bit float	Uncompressed, best quality.
AIFF 24-bit	Uncompressed (popular on Mac).
FLAC 16 / 24-bit	Lossless compression.
OGG Vorbis 192 kbps	Compressed.
MP3 320 / 192 kbps	Compressed – needs ffmpeg*.
M4A / AAC 256 kbps, Apple Lossless	Needs ffmpeg*.
Opus 160 kbps	Needs ffmpeg*.

* ffmpeg is included with the Windows and macOS installers. On Linux install it with `sudo apt install ffmpeg`.

14. Undo, zoom and settings

- **Undo/Redo**: the arrow buttons or `Ctrl+Z` / `Ctrl+Y`. Each track has its own history.
- **Zoom**: the magnifiers, the slider, `+` / `−`, `0` (whole track) or `Ctrl`+mouse wheel. The mouse wheel alone scrolls sideways. Click/drag in the overview to move the view.
- **Settings** (gear): Audio settings, Language (English/Danish – requires restart), Keyboard shortcuts and About.

15. Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Function	Key	Function
`Space`	Play / stop	`Ctrl+X/C/V`	Cut / copy / paste
`R`	Record	`Delete`	Delete selection
`Home`	Go to start	`Ctrl+T`	Trim
`L`	Loop on/off	`Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y`	Undo / redo
`M`	New marker	`Ctrl+O`	Open files
`Ctrl+A`	Select all	`Ctrl+N`	New empty track
`+ / − / 0`	Zoom in / out / fit	`Ctrl+E`	Export

On a Mac use `Cmd` instead of `Ctrl`.

16. Troubleshooting

- **No sound**: check the output device under **Settings → Audio settings**.
- **Recording does not work**: choose an input device and enable input channels in Audio settings. On macOS allow microphone access under System Settings → Privacy & Security → Microphone.
- **MP3/M4A/Opus is greyed out**: ffmpeg was not found. Install ffmpeg (Linux: `sudo apt install ffmpeg`, macOS: `brew install ffmpeg`).
- **A file cannot be opened**: the format may require ffmpeg (e.g. M4A on Linux).
- **macOS says the app is damaged**: run `xattr -cr "/Applications/Artilody Soundsculp.app"` in Terminal.

Report bugs and wishes on GitHub under **Issues**. Artilody Soundsculp is free software under the GPL-3.0 and is built with JUCE.